CATS INSIGHTS

Student-Led Academic Publication

OPERATIONAL ROADMAP

Academic Year 2025-2026

Target Publication: September 2026

Version 2.0 | February 2026

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The Worthgate School, CATS Global Schools

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I. Executive Summary

This document serves as the comprehensive operational roadmap for CATS Insights, a student-led academic publication at The Worthgate School. It provides complete context for new members, establishes clear timelines and milestones, and ensures institutional continuity.

1.1 Mission Statement

> *"To create a student-run academic publication that showcases rigorous STEM scholarship, provides valuable super-curricular opportunities, and establishes The Worthgate School as a leader in student academic achievement."*

1.2 Critical Milestones

Milestone	Description	Target Date
RSC Award Submission	Complete multi-category entry for RSC Kent Young Chemist Award	**31 Mar 2026**
All Articles RFD	All Edition 1 articles pass QA and marked Ready for Design	**30 Jun 2026**
Design Complete	Full magazine layout finalized and approved	**15 Aug 2026**
EDITION 1 LAUNCH	Digital publication release across all CATS Global Schools	**Sep 2026**

II. Organizational Context

2.1 What is CATS Insights?

CATS Insights is a student-led academic publication initiative at The Worthgate School, part of CATS Global Schools. Founded in late 2025 by Kyal Sin Ye Yint (Jason), it represents a reconceptualization of the successful HIS Insight model from Harrow International School Bangkok, adapted and enhanced for the CATS environment.

2.2 The Model and Vision

- **Primary Focus:** STEM scholarship accessible to educated non-specialists
- **Writing Level:** Level 2 (Educated Non-Specialist) - scientifically rigorous yet readable
- **Special Focus:** "The Chemistry of Kent" - connecting science to local landmarks and history
- **Long-term Vision:** Expand to all 7 CATS Global Schools as an inter-school publication

2.3 Current Team Structure

The organization operates under a clear three-tier command hierarchy to prevent decision paralysis and ensure accountability:

Tier	Role	Current Holder(s)
STRATEGIC	**President**	Kyal Sin Ye Yint (Jason)
	Vice President	Alex
OPERATIONAL	Lead Editor	Grisha (Deputy: Daniel)
	Lead Writer	Philip
	Lead Designer	Elain (Deputy: Kateryna)
	Head of Academic Dev	Cindy (Deputy: Tobb)
	QA Lead	Nana (Deputy: Tory)
	Head of Community Outreach	STO (San Thit Oo)
EXECUTION	General Members	Writers, Editors, Designers (~22 total)

2.4 The Digital Infrastructure

- **Microsoft Teams:** Primary communication platform for announcements, channels, and team collaboration

- **Google Drive:** Centralized file storage for all documents, drafts, and resources
- **Google Sheets (Master Operations Dashboard):** Single source of truth for tracking attendance, hours, article pipeline, and QA metrics
- **Instagram:** Primary marketing and community engagement platform

Core Principle: "If it isn't documented in the Master Sheet, it doesn't exist." This ensures accountability and institutional memory.

III. Historical Timeline (What Has Happened)

This section provides complete context for any new member joining the organization. Understanding our history is essential for understanding where we are going.

3.1 Founding Phase (September - November 2025)

September - October 2025: Conception

- Jason developed initial proposal based on HIS Insight model from Harrow Bangkok
- Conducted critical analysis of HIS Insight's strengths and limitations
- Drafted comprehensive project proposal with constitution framework
- Requested Miss Emma as faculty advisor

November 2025: Official Launch

13 November 2025 - First Official Meeting:

- Leadership team announced and roles assigned
- Foundational document creation delegated (deadline: 25 Nov)
- 22 initial members recruited across Writer, Editor, and Designer tracks

20 November 2025 - Second Meeting:

- Established Teams channels and communication protocols
- Created library sub-committee (Nana, Le, Luisa)
- Announced transition from interim to permanent roles based on performance
- Mandatory attendance policy announced for post-Christmas break

3.2 Building Phase (December 2025 - January 2026)

December 2025: Parallel Initiatives

- **Christmas Festivities Team:** Winter Ball, Secret Santa, recycled decorations (~£200 raised for charity)
- **Elective Launch Team:** Marketing slides and recruitment materials prepared for next term
- **Academic Development Team:** Foundational documents drafted during break

January 2026: Institutional Foundation

- RSC Kent Young Chemist Award strategy developed
- School nomination secured through strategic lobbying
- 45-document Institutional Knowledge Suite planning begun
- 6-stage delegation system formalized to prevent "ghosting"

3.3 Current State (February 2026)

Where We Stand Right Now:

- **Team Size:** ~27 members across all departments
- **Foundational Documents:** In progress - Writer's Guide, Citation Protocol, Editorial Handbook, QA Checklist, Style Guide
- **Workshop Delivered:** "Writing Chemistry for Non-Chemists" (45 min, 12 slides)
- **Blog Post Published:** "The Albedo of Antiquity" - White Cliffs of Dover chemistry article
- **RSC Award:** Evidence portfolio building in progress (deadline 31 March)
- **Distribution Partnerships:** Confirmed across all 7 CATS Global Schools

IV. Master Timeline to September 2026

This section provides the detailed chronological roadmap from our current position to publication. All dates are firm targets unless marked as flexible.

4.1 Phase Overview

Phase	Dates	Primary Objective
Phase 1	Feb 6 - Mar 31	RSC Award Sprint + Foundation Completion
Phase 2	Apr 1 - Apr 30	Article Planning & Topic Assignment
Phase 3	May 1 - Jun 30	Writing Sprint + Editorial Processing
Phase 4	Jul 1 - Aug 15	Design, Layout & Final QA
Phase 5	Aug 16 - Aug 31	Final Review & Pre-Launch Prep
LAUNCH	**September 2026**	**Edition 1 Publication Release**

4.2 Phase 1: RSC Award Sprint (Feb 6 - Mar 31)

CRITICAL DEADLINE: RSC Kent Young Chemist Award submission closes 31 March 2026

Week 1-2 (Feb 6-21): Evidence Building

1. Complete workshop delivery documentation (video clips, attendance logs)
2. Publish 2nd blog post (Kent chemistry focus - Canterbury Cathedral or Rochester Castle)
3. Document mentoring activities with before/after writing samples
4. Create Instagram carousel for Dover article (5 slides)
5. Complete remaining foundational documents

Week 3-4 (Feb 22 - Mar 7): Artifact Creation

6. Create 2-minute video showcasing chemistry outreach impact
7. Develop downloadable teaching resource for secondary teachers
8. Compile testimonials from workshop participants
9. Finalize 3-Level Framework as distributable resource

Week 5-6 (Mar 8-21): Application Drafting

10. Draft multi-category entry (Digital Outreach + Mentoring + History of Chemistry)
11. Faculty advisor review (Miss Emma)
12. Quantify impact metrics (reach, engagement, participants trained)

Week 7-8 (Mar 22-31): Final Submission

13. Polish application language and proofread
14. Verify all links and attachments function correctly
15. **Submit by 31 March 2026 (no extensions)**

Parallel Track: Foundation Completion

While the RSC Award is the priority, continue background work on:

- Writer's Guide finalization
- Editorial Handbook completion
- QA Checklist operationalization
- Instagram account launch and initial posts

4.3 Phase 2: Article Planning (Apr 1-30)

Week 1 (Apr 1-7): Edition 1 Architecture

16. Establish Edition 1 theme (recommended: "Science in Our Backyard" - Kent focus)
17. Determine article count (target: 8-12 articles)
18. Define section categories (Features, Research Spotlights, Science History, Kent Chemistry)

Week 2 (Apr 8-14): Topic Assignment

19. Review Topic Menu with all writers
20. Match writers to topics based on interest and capability
21. Assign Deputies to each article per delegation system
22. Create article tracking entries in Master Sheet

Week 3-4 (Apr 15-30): Pre-Writing Preparation

23. Writers complete preliminary research outlines
24. Identify source materials and key references
25. Academic Development conducts Writer Workshop (source evaluation, structure)
26. Design team begins visual identity development for Edition 1

Easter Break Note: Reduced availability expected. Focus on individual research that doesn't require team coordination.

4.4 Phase 3: Writing Sprint (May 1 - Jun 30)

EXAM PERIOD AWARENESS: A-Level exams typically run May-June. Adjust workloads for Year 13 members.

May 1-15: First Draft Completion

27. All writers submit complete first drafts
28. Target word count per article: 1,500-2,500 words
29. Minimum 3 credible sources per article
30. Oxford referencing format required

May 16-31: Peer Review Cycle 1

31. Editors conduct structural review (thesis clarity, argument flow, evidence strength)
32. Feedback returned to writers within 7 days
33. Writers complete revisions

Jun 1-15: Peer Review Cycle 2 + Line Editing

34. Editors conduct line-level editing (grammar, style, SI units, British English)
35. Lead Editor final pass on each article
36. Citation verification begins

Jun 16-30: Quality Assurance Gate

37. **Turnitin check (<20% similarity excluding bibliography)**
38. **GPTZero AI detection screening**
39. DOI verification for all referenced papers
40. Fact-checking for scientific claims
41. **Articles passing QA marked RFD (Ready for Design)**

Target: All articles RFD by 30 June 2026

4.5 Phase 4: Design & Layout (Jul 1 - Aug 15)

Jul 1-15: Template Finalization

42. Finalize magazine template (12-column grid, Major Third typographic scale)
43. Confirm color palette (Harrow Blue #0C2340, Harrow Gold #89764B)
44. Create master page layouts for article types
45. Design cover concepts (3 options for selection)

Jul 16-31: Article Layout

46. Place all RFD articles into layout
47. Source or create images, diagrams, and infographics
48. Ensure image credits and licensing compliance
49. Author bios and headshots collected

Aug 1-15: Polish & Refinement

50. Complete table of contents and navigation
51. Add editor's note and contributor acknowledgments
52. Final typography check (widows, orphans, hyphenation)
53. PDF export and digital accessibility check

Target: Complete layout by 15 August 2026

4.6 Phase 5: Final Review (Aug 16-31)

Aug 16-23: Faculty & Stakeholder Review

54. Miss Emma (Faculty Advisor) full edition review
55. Principal office approval (brand compliance)
56. Optional: External expert review for flagship articles

Aug 24-31: Pre-Launch Preparation

57. Final corrections implemented
58. Marketing materials prepared (social media posts, email announcements)
59. Distribution list confirmed for all 7 CATS Global Schools
60. Website publication page prepared
61. Launch event logistics finalized

4.7 Launch: September 2026

EDITION 1 PUBLICATION

Launch Week Activities

62. Digital publication release on website
63. Email distribution to all CATS Global Schools
64. Social media campaign (Instagram, potentially LinkedIn)
65. In-school launch event (if feasible)
66. Contributor recognition and certificates

V. Visual Timeline (Gantt Chart)

The following table provides a visual representation of all phases and their overlap. Each column represents approximately 2 weeks.

Phase	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep
RSC Award	■	■						
Article Planning			■					
Writing Sprint				■	■			
Design & Layout						■	■	
Final Review							■	
LAUNCH								★

Legend: RSC Award Planning Writing Design Review ★ Launch

VI. Quality Standards & Procedures

6.1 The Three-Test Framework

Every published article must pass all three tests:

Test	Question	Standard
Specialist Test	Would an expert in this field find any factual errors?	Zero scientific inaccuracies; all claims verifiable
Peer Test	Can an A-Level student follow the argument clearly?	Level 2 readability; technical terms explained
Citation Test	Can every claim be traced to a credible source?	Oxford format; DOIs included; min. 3 sources

6.2 QA Thresholds

- **Turnitin Similarity:** <20% (excluding bibliography and common phrases)
- **AI Detection (GPTZero):** No significant AI-generated content detected
- **Maximum Revision Cycles:** 3 (after which article is escalated or rejected)

6.3 The 6-Stage Delegation System

All work flows through this closed-loop system to prevent "ghosting" (claimed but incomplete work):

67. **Strategic Brief:** President/VP defines Work Packet with clear requirements
68. **Claim & Assignment:** Captain claims task and assigns specific member + Deputy
69. **Execution:** Member completes work using Official Handbooks
70. **Peer Review:** Editorial team provides structural and line-level feedback
71. **Quality Assurance:** QA Lead verifies Turnitin, AI detection, citations
72. **Final Approval:** President signs off; work marked RFD in Master Sheet

Escalation Timeline: Day 1 past deadline = Captain contacts member. Day 3 = Deputy assumes responsibility. Day 5 = VP intervenes. Day 7+ = Bottleneck alert triggered.

VII. Weekly Meeting Schedule

7.1 Standing Meeting Structure

When: Every Thursday, 4:05 PM - 5:00 PM

Where: School Library or designated classroom

Attendance: Mandatory from Term 2 onwards (unexcused absence = removal)

7.2 Standard Agenda Template

73. Opening & Attendance (5 min)
74. President's Strategic Update (10 min)
75. Departmental Reports (20 min)
    - Academic Development, Editorial & QA, Design & Media, Community Outreach
76. New Work Packet Claims (15 min)
77. Problem-Solving Discussion (10 min)
78. Action Item Review by VP (10 min)
79. Closing & Next Meeting Date (5 min)

7.3 Post-Meeting Protocol

- Secretaries finalize Meeting Minutes within 24 hours
- Minutes distributed to all members (including absentees)
- Master Timeline updated with new tasks
- Absent members receive specific catch-up instructions

VIII. Appendices

A. Foundational Document Links

- **Writer's Guide:** docs.google.com/document/d/128zV3_FVLWLGEY7sDsB-nPnPEyB1GaDr7TNuKRpwvHs
- **Citation Protocol (Oxford):** docs.google.com/document/d/1OuOHg-rVQJ-DazqHAmOcAWFdT1bwjhNegD0LagImGCM
- **Article Topic Menu:** docs.google.com/document/d/1fOdqETG1oAR_asbaiHv28pOOAEo84SbgC5LmCx2J_ew
- **Editorial Handbook:** docs.google.com/document/d/1KBDkMv2k4Xqn2q0j6xYngjjJj6aq_Zh67qb_jY7t5GA
- **QA Checklist:** docs.google.com/document/d/1esNqkv7TjAHBHSu9DiDtUvjqKX3g0rvhhW3Q97taV_U
- **Visual Style Guide:** docs.google.com/document/d/1w41VK_ZZuge89SDNeUf78VdiJgNmCIqlOPClAlCKpk8U
- **Constitution:** docs.google.com/document/d/19W2xmE1hvQr-00FnT4aueJc2qyPB_7tqGR981NO6MkI

B. Key Personnel Contact

President (Strategic Lead): Kyal Sin Ye Yint (Jason)

Vice President (Tactical Oversight): Alex

Faculty Advisor: Miss Emma

IT Support: Miss Julie

C. Version History

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	Nov 2025	Initial draft with basic timeline
2.0	**Feb 2026**	Complete restructure with RSC integration, detailed phases, Gantt chart, historical context for onboarding

End of Document

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